

	Formal discussion (meetings)
C2	Can hold their own in formal discussion of complex issues, putting an articulate and persuasive argument, at no disadvantage to other participants. Can advise on/handle complex, delicate or contentious issues, provided they have the necessary specialised knowledge. Can deal with hostile questioning confidently, hold on to the turn and diplomatically rebut counter-arguments.
C1	Can easily keep up with the debate, even on abstract, complex, unfamiliar topics. Can argue a formal position convincingly, responding to questions and comments and answering complex lines of counter-argument fluently, spontaneously and appropriately. Can restate, evaluate and challenge contributions from other participants about matters within their academic or professional competence. Can make critical remarks or express disagreement diplomatically. Can follow up questions by probing for more detail and can reformulate questions if these are misunderstood.
B2	Can keep up with an animated discussion, identifying accurately arguments supporting and opposing points of view. Can use appropriate technical terminology when discussing their area of specialisation with other specialists. Can express their ideas and opinions with precision, and present and respond to complex lines of argument convincingly. Can participate actively in routine and non-routine formal discussion. Can follow the discussion on matters related to their field, understand in detail the points given prominence. Can contribute, account for and sustain their opinion, evaluate alternative proposals and make and respond to hypotheses.
B1	Can follow much of what is said that is related to their field, provided interlocutors avoid very idiomatic usage and articulate clearly. Can put over a point of view clearly, but has difficulty engaging in debate. Can take part in routine formal discussion of familiar subjects which is clearly articulated in the standard form of the language or a familiar variety and which involves the exchange of factual information, receiving instructions or the discussion of solutions to practical problems. Can follow argumentation and discussion on a familiar or predictable topic, provided the points are made in relatively simple language and/or repeated, and opportunity is given for clarification.
A2	Can generally follow changes of topic in formal discussion related to their field which is conducted slowly and clearly. Can exchange relevant information and give their opinion on practical problems when asked directly, provided they receive some help with formulation and can ask for repetition of key points if necessary. Can express what they think about things when addressed directly in a formal meeting, provided they can ask for repetition of key points if necessary.
A1	<i>No descriptors available</i>
Pre-A1	<i>No descriptors available</i>

Goal-oriented co-operation

This scale concerns collaborative, task-focused work, which is a daily occurrence in real life, especially in professional contexts. As with the conversation and discussion scales, this scale includes similar descriptors on the ability to follow discussion. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ following the discussion: from understanding simple instructions explained directly to them to understanding detailed instructions reliably;
- ▶ active contribution to the work: from simply asking for things and giving things to speculating about causes and consequences and organising the entire task.

	Goal-oriented co-operation (cooking together, discussing a document, organising an event, etc.)
C2	<i>No descriptors available; see C1</i>
C1	Can frame a discussion to decide on a course of action with a partner or group, reporting on what others have said, and summarising, elaborating and weighing up multiple points of view.
B2	Can understand detailed instructions reliably. Can help along the progress of the work by inviting others to join in, express what they think, etc. Can outline an issue or a problem clearly, speculating about causes or consequences, and weighing advantages and disadvantages of different approaches.
B1	Can follow what is said, though they may occasionally have to ask for repetition or clarification if the discussion is rapid or extended. Can explain why something is a problem, discuss what to do next, and compare and contrast alternatives. Can give brief comments on the views of others.
	Can generally follow what is said and, when necessary, repeat back part of what someone has said to confirm mutual understanding. Can make their opinions and reactions understood as regards possible solutions or the question of what to do next, giving brief reasons and explanations. Can invite others to give their views on how to proceed.
A2	Can understand enough to manage simple, routine tasks without undue effort, asking very simply for repetition when they do not understand. Can discuss what to do next, making and responding to suggestions, and asking for and giving directions.
	Can indicate when they are following and can be made to understand what is necessary, if the interlocutor takes the trouble. Can communicate in simple and routine tasks using simple phrases to ask for and provide things, to get simple information and to discuss what to do next.
A1	Can understand questions and instructions addressed carefully and slowly to them and follow short, simple directions. Can act on basic instructions that involve times, locations, numbers, etc. Can ask people for things, and give people things.
Pre-A1	<i>No descriptors available</i>

Obtaining goods and services

This scale mainly concerns service encounters in restaurants, shops, banks, etc. Effectively making a complaint appears at B1, and above this level the scale focuses on following up a complaint or problem and negotiating a solution. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ types of situation: from simple everyday transactions to disputes about responsibility and sensitive transactions in public, professional or academic life;
- ▶ getting service: from asking for food and drink to asking detailed questions about more complex services;
- ▶ demanding satisfaction: from making a complaint (B1) to negotiating a solution to a dispute or a sensitive transaction.

	Obtaining goods and services
C2	<i>No descriptors available; see C1</i>
C1	Can negotiate complex or sensitive transactions in public, professional or academic life.
B2	Can cope linguistically to negotiate a solution to a dispute like an undeserved traffic ticket, financial responsibility for damage in a flat, or blame regarding an accident. Can outline a case for compensation, using persuasive language to demand satisfaction and state clearly the limits to any concession they are prepared to make. Can state requirements and ask detailed questions regarding more complex services, e.g. rental agreements. Can explain a problem which has arisen and make it clear that the provider of the service/customer must make a concession.
B1	Can deal with most transactions likely to arise while travelling, arranging travel or accommodation, or dealing with authorities during a foreign visit. Can ask in a shop for an explanation of the difference between two or more products serving the same purpose, in order to make a decision, posing follow-up questions as necessary. Can cope with less routine situations in shops, post offices, banks, e.g. returning an unsatisfactory purchase. Can make a complaint. Can deal with most situations likely to arise when making travel arrangements through an agent or when actually travelling, e.g. asking a passenger where to get off for an unfamiliar destination.
A2	Can deal with common aspects of everyday living such as travel, lodging, eating and shopping. Can interact in predictable everyday situations (e.g. post office, station, shop), using a wide range of simple expressions. Can get all the information needed from a tourist office, as long as it is of a straightforward, non-specialised nature. Can ask for and provide everyday goods and services. Can get simple information about travel, use public transport (e.g. buses, trains, taxis), ask and give directions, and buy tickets. Can ask about things and make simple transactions in shops, post offices or banks. Can give and receive information about quantities, numbers, prices, etc. Can make simple purchases by stating what is wanted and asking the price. Can order a meal. Can point out when something is wrong (e.g. "The food is cold" or "There is no light in my room"). Can ask (face-to-face) for a medical appointment and understand the reply. Can indicate the nature of a problem to a health professional, perhaps using gestures and body language.
A1	Can ask people for things and give people things. Can ask for food and drink using basic expressions. Can handle numbers, quantities, cost and time.
Pre-A1	Can make simple purchases and/or order food or drink when pointing or other gesture can support the verbal reference.

Information exchange

This scale does not contain descriptors for the C levels, because merely exchanging factual information is no longer a main focus in learning objectives for proficient users. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ type of transaction: from simple questions, instructions and directions, through simple, routine exchanges, to exchanging information with other specialists;
- ▶ type of information: from personal details, dates, prices, etc., through habits, routines, pastimes and straightforward factual information, to detailed and complex information or advice.

	Information exchange
C2	<i>No descriptors available; see B2</i>
C1	<i>No descriptors available; see B2</i>
B2	Can understand and exchange complex information and advice on the full range of matters related to their occupational role. Can use appropriate technical terminology when exchanging information or discussing their area of specialisation with other specialists. Can pass on detailed information reliably.
B1	Can exchange, check and confirm accumulated factual information on familiar routine and non-routine matters within their field with some confidence. Can summarise and give their opinion about a short story, article, talk, discussion, interview or documentary and answer further questions of detail. Can find out and pass on straightforward factual information. Can ask for and follow detailed directions. Can obtain more detailed information. Can offer advice on simple matters within their field of experience.
A2	Can understand enough to manage simple, routine exchanges without undue effort. Can deal with practical everyday demands: finding out and passing on straightforward factual information. Can ask and answer questions about habits and routines. Can ask and answer questions about pastimes and past activities. Can ask and answer questions about plans and intentions. Can give and follow simple directions and instructions, e.g. explain how to get somewhere. Can communicate in simple and routine tasks requiring a simple and direct exchange of information. Can exchange limited information on familiar and routine operational matters. Can ask and answer questions about what they do at work and in their free time. Can ask for and give directions referring to a map or plan. Can ask for and provide personal information. Can ask and answer simple questions about an event (e.g. ask where and when it took place, who was there and what it was like).
A1	Can understand questions and instructions addressed carefully and slowly to them and follow short, simple directions. Can ask and answer simple questions, initiate and respond to simple statements in areas of immediate need or on very familiar topics. Can ask and answer questions about themselves and other people, where they live, people they know, things they have. Can indicate time by lexicalised phrases like "next week", "last Friday", "in November", "3 o'clock". Can express numbers, quantities and cost in a limited way. Can name the colour of clothes or other familiar objects and can ask the colour of such objects.
Pre-A1	Can tell people their name and ask other people their names. Can use and understand simple numbers in everyday conversations. Can ask and tell what day, time of day and date it is. Can ask for and give a date of birth. Can ask for and give a phone number. Can tell people their age and ask people about their age. Can ask very simple questions for information, such as "What is this?" and understand one- or two-word/ sign answers.

Interviewing and being interviewed

This scale concerns the specialised roles associated with doctor's appointments and job applications as well as other forms of examination, plus surveys and, in an educational context, projects. In relation to signing, there is an assumption that the interlocutor can also sign. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ independence from the interlocutor: from requiring direct, slow, clear standard language to acting without any support, at no disadvantage to the other person(s);
- ▶ taking the initiative: from bringing up new subjects (B1) to participating fully, developing a point fluently and handling interjections well;
- ▶ conducting the actual interview: from using a prepared questionnaire (B1), through departing spontaneously from prepared questions and following up and probing interesting replies, to structuring the discourse and interacting authoritatively.

	Interviewing and being interviewed
C2	Can keep up their side of the dialogue extremely well, structuring the discourse and interacting authoritatively with effortless fluency as interviewer or interviewee, at no disadvantage to other participants.
C1	Can participate fully in an interview, as either interviewer or interviewee, expanding and developing the point being discussed fluently without any support, and handling interjections well.
B2	Can carry out an effective, fluent interview, departing spontaneously from prepared questions, following up and probing interesting replies. Can take the initiative in an interview, and expand and develop ideas with little help or prodding from an interviewer.
B1	Can provide concrete information required in an interview/consultation (e.g. describe symptoms to a doctor), but with limited precision. Can carry out a prepared interview, checking and confirming information, though they may occasionally have to ask for repetition if the other person's response is rapid or extended. Can take some initiative in an interview/consultation (e.g. to bring up a new subject) but is very dependent on the interviewer in the interaction. Can describe symptoms in a simple way and ask for advice when using health services, and can understand the answer, provided this is given clearly in everyday language. Can use a prepared questionnaire to carry out a structured interview, with some spontaneous follow-up questions.
A2	Can make themselves understood in an interview and communicate ideas and information on familiar topics, provided they can ask for clarification occasionally, and are given some help to express what they want to. Can describe to a doctor very basic symptoms and ailments such as a cold or the flu. Can answer simple questions and respond to simple statements in an interview. Can indicate in simple language the nature of a problem to a health professional, perhaps using gestures and body language.
A1	Can reply in an interview to simple direct questions, put very slowly and clearly in direct, non-idiomatic language, about personal details. Can state in simple language the nature of a problem to a health professional and answer simple questions such as "Does that hurt?" even though they have to rely on gestures and body language to reinforce the message.
Pre-A1	<i>No descriptors available</i>

Using telecommunications

This new 2018 scale concerns use of the phone and internet-based apps for remote communication. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ range of information and transactions involved: from simple messages and conversations on predictable topics like arrival times, routine messages and basic services to use for a variety of personal and professional purposes;
- ▶ interlocutor: from a known person to unknown persons with less familiar accents;
- ▶ length of exchange: from short, simple exchanges to extended casual conversation.

	Using telecommunications
C2	Can use telecommunications confidently and effectively for both personal and professional purposes, even if there is some interference (noise) or the caller has a less familiar accent.
C1	Can use telecommunications effectively for most professional or personal purposes.
B2	Can use telecommunications for a variety of personal and professional purposes, provided they can ask for clarification if the accent or terminology is unfamiliar. Can participate in extended casual conversation over the phone with a known person on a variety of topics.
B1	Can use telecommunications for everyday personal or professional purposes, provided they can ask for clarification from time to time. Can give important details over the (video)phone concerning an unexpected incident (e.g. a problem in a hotel, with travel arrangements, with a hire car). Can use telecommunications to have relatively simple but extended conversations with people they know personally. Can use telecommunications for routine messages (e.g. arrangements for a meeting) and to obtain basic services (e.g. book a hotel room or make a medical appointment).
A2	Can use telecommunications with their friends to exchange simple news, make plans and arrange to meet. Can, given repetition and clarifications, participate in a short, simple phone conversation with a known person on a predictable topic, e.g. arrival times, arrangements to meet. Can understand a simple message (e.g. "My flight is late. I will arrive at 10 o'clock."), confirm details of the message and pass it on by phone to other people concerned.
A1	<i>No descriptors available</i>
Pre-A1	<i>No descriptors available</i>

3.3.1.2. Written interaction

Written interaction concerns interactive communication through the medium of script or sign.⁴³ There are two scales: "Correspondence" and "Notes, messages and forms". The former focuses on an interpersonal exchange, while the latter concerns information transfer. In written interaction the language used is similar to oral language.

43. The number of formal and informal video-recorded chats and message exchanges has been rising rapidly, most notably through WhatsApp. Signers may correspond in writing or sign – or even switch between the two. In some countries, signers can now send enquiries, comments and complaints to certain service providers through a dedicated web portal. In addition, there are an increasing number of online surveys in which signers can choose whether to answer the questions in writing or in their sign language. The verb "compose" is therefore used in this section to include the possibility of signing.

In addition, most interactive situations are tolerant of some error and confusion and have some contextual support. There is usually an opportunity to use interaction strategies like asking for clarification or asking for help with formulation and to repair misunderstandings. Finally, the requirement to produce carefully structured, accurate text is less of a priority.

Online interaction is dealt with separately because it is multimodal (see next section).

Overall written interaction

	Overall written interaction
C2	Can express themselves in an appropriate tone and style in virtually any type of formal and informal interaction.
C1	Can express themselves with clarity and precision, relating to the addressee flexibly and effectively.
B2	Can express news and views effectively in writing, and relate to those of others.
B1	Can convey information and ideas on abstract as well as concrete topics, check information, and ask about or explain problems with reasonable precision.
	Can compose personal letters and notes asking for or conveying simple information of immediate relevance, getting across the point they feel to be important.
A2	Can compose short, simple formulaic notes relating to matters in areas of immediate need.
A1	Can ask for or pass on personal details.
Pre-A1	Can convey basic information (e.g. name, address, family) in short phrases on a form or in a note, with the use of a dictionary.

Correspondence

The 2001 scale concerned only personal correspondence. The update augments this with descriptors for formal correspondence, since this is an activity that some user/learners need to carry out. Key concepts operationalised in the scale therefore include the following:

- ▶ type of message: from simple, personal messages, to in-depth, personal and professional correspondence;
- ▶ type of language: from formulaic expressions to emotional, allusive and joking usage and writing with good expression in an appropriate tone and style.

	Correspondence
C2	Can compose virtually any type of correspondence necessary in the course of their professional life in an appropriate tone and style.
C1	Can express themselves with clarity and precision in personal correspondence, using language flexibly and effectively, including emotional, allusive and joking usage.
	Can, with good expression and accuracy, compose formal correspondence such as letters of clarification, application, recommendation, reference, complaint, sympathy and condolence.
B2+	Can maintain a relationship through personal correspondence using the language fluently and effectively to give detailed descriptions of experiences, pose sympathetic questions and follow up issues of mutual interest.
	Can in most cases understand idiomatic expressions and colloquialisms in correspondence and other communications and use the most common ones themselves as appropriate to the situation.
	Can compose formal correspondence such as letters of enquiry, request, application and complaint using appropriate register, structure and conventions.
	Can compose a forceful but polite letter of complaint, including supporting details and a statement of the desired outcome.

	Correspondence
B2	Can compose letters conveying degrees of emotion and highlighting the personal significance of events and experiences and commenting on the correspondent's news and views. Can use formality and conventions appropriate to the context when writing personal and professional letters and e-mails. Can compose formal e-mails/letters of invitation, thanks or apology using appropriate registers and conventions. Can compose non-routine professional letters, using appropriate structure and conventions, provided these are restricted to matters of fact. Can obtain, by letter or e-mail, information required for a particular purpose, collate it and forward it by e-mail to other people.
B1	Can compose personal letters giving news and expressing thoughts about abstract or cultural topics such as music or film. Can compose letters expressing different opinions and giving detailed accounts of personal feelings and experiences. Can reply to an advertisement in writing and ask for further information on items that interest them. Can compose basic formal e-mails/letters (e.g. to make a complaint and request action).
	Can compose personal letters describing experiences, feelings and events in some detail. Can compose basic e-mails/letters of a factual nature (e.g. to request information or to ask for and give confirmation). Can compose a basic letter of application with limited supporting details.
A2	Can exchange information by text message, by e-mail or in short letters, responding to questions from the other person (e.g. about a new product or activity). Can convey personal information of a routine nature, for example in a short e-mail or letter introducing themselves. Can compose very simple personal letters expressing thanks and apology. Can compose short, simple notes, e-mails and text messages (e.g. to send or reply to an invitation, to confirm or change an arrangement). Can compose a short text in a greetings card (e.g. for someone's birthday or to wish them a Happy New Year).
A1	Can compose messages and online postings as a series of very short sentences about hobbies and likes/dislikes, using simple words and formulaic expressions, with reference to a dictionary. Can compose a short, simple postcard. Can compose a short, very simple message (e.g. a text message) to friends to give them a piece of information or to ask them a question.
Pre-A1	Can convey basic personal information in short phrases and sentences, with reference to a dictionary.

Notes, messages and forms

This scale encompasses a range of transactional interactive writing. At the A levels it includes filling in forms with personal details. From A2 the focus is on taking or leaving messages and writing/signing short notes. Key concepts operationalised in the scale therefore include the following:

- ▶ filling in forms with personal details (Pre-A1 to A2);
- ▶ leaving and taking messages, from simple messages about time, through messages containing several points, to complex personal or professional messages;
- ▶ formulating notes: from short and simple to more developed notes to friends, service people, teachers, etc.

	Notes, messages and forms
C2	<i>No descriptors available; see B2</i>
C1	<i>No descriptors available; see B2</i>
B2	Can take or leave complex personal or professional messages, provided they can ask for clarification or elaboration if necessary.
B1	Can take routine messages that are likely to occur in a personal, professional or academic context. Can take messages communicating enquiries and explaining problems.
	Can formulate notes conveying simple information of immediate relevance to friends, service people, teachers and others who feature in their everyday life, getting across comprehensibly the points they feel are important.
	Can take messages over the phone containing several points, provided the caller dictates these clearly and sympathetically.
A2	Can take a short, simple message provided they can ask for repetition and reformulation.
	Can formulate short, simple notes and messages relating to matters in areas of immediate need. Can fill in personal and other details on most everyday forms (e.g. to open a bank account, or to send a letter by recorded delivery).
A1	Can fill in numbers and dates, own name, nationality, address, age, date of birth or arrival in the country, etc., e.g. on a hotel registration form.
	Can leave a simple message giving information regarding for instance where they have gone, or what time they will be back (e.g. "Shopping: back at 5 p.m.").
Pre-A1	Can fill in very simple registration forms with basic personal details: name, address, nationality, marital status.

3.3.1.3. Online interaction

Online communication is always mediated through a machine, which implies that it is unlikely ever to be exactly the same as face-to-face interaction. There are emergent properties of group interaction online that are almost impossible to capture in traditional competence scales focusing on the individual's behaviour in speech, signing or in writing. For instance, there is an availability of resources shared in real time. On the other hand, there may be misunderstandings that are not spotted (and corrected) immediately, as is often easier with face-to-face communication. Some requirements for successful communication are:

- ▶ the need for more redundancy in messages;
- ▶ the need to check that the message has been correctly understood;
- ▶ ability to reformulate in order to help comprehension and deal with misunderstandings;
- ▶ ability to handle emotional reactions.

Online conversation and discussion

This scale focuses on conversation and discussion online as a multimodal phenomenon, with an emphasis on how interlocutors communicate online to handle both serious issues and social exchanges in an open-ended way. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ instances of simultaneous (real-time) and consecutive interaction, the latter allowing time to prepare a draft and/or consult aids;
- ▶ participation in sustained interaction with one or more interlocutors;
- ▶ composing posts and contributions for others to respond to;
- ▶ comments (for example, evaluative) on the posts, comments and contributions of others;
- ▶ reactions to embedded media;
- ▶ the ability to include symbols, images and other codes to make the message convey tone, stress and prosody, but also the affective/emotional side, irony, etc.

Progression up the scale is characterised as follows: the move from lower to higher levels is accompanied by a shift from simple social exchanges and personal news towards a broader range of competences encompassing professional and educational discursive interaction at the C levels, with the introduction of real-time interaction and group interaction from B1+. B2 is characterised by the ability to participate actively in discussion and argument, linking a contribution effectively to others in the thread, and repairing misunderstandings appropriately. By C1, the user/learner can modulate their register and give critical evaluations diplomatically. At C2, they can anticipate and deal effectively with possible misunderstandings (including cultural ones), communication issues and emotional reactions. Progression can also be seen as the process of adding virtual “spaces” in which the user/learner can interact such as a “café”, “classroom” or “meeting room”. A user/learner will struggle to interact successfully in an online meeting until they reach the B levels, will be able to interact in a virtual “classroom” at A2 only if carefully guided, and maybe can communicate only very superficially at A1 when posting and chatting in the “café”. At the C levels, on the other hand, the user/learner can adapt their register and interaction style according to the virtual space they are in, adjusting their language appropriately to make communication more effective.

	Online conversation and discussion
C2	Can express themselves with clarity and precision in real-time online discussion, adjusting language flexibly and sensitively to context, including emotional, allusive and joking usage. Can anticipate and deal effectively with possible misunderstandings (including cultural ones), communication issues and emotional reactions in an online discussion. Can easily and quickly adapt their register and style to suit different online environments, communication purposes and speech acts.
C1	Can engage in real-time online exchanges with several participants, understanding the communicative intentions and cultural implications of the various contributions. Can participate effectively in live, online professional or academic discussion, asking for and giving further clarification of complex, abstract issues as necessary. Can adapt their register according to the context of online interaction, moving from one register to the other within the same exchange if necessary. Can evaluate, restate and challenge arguments in professional or academic live online chat and discussion.
B2	Can engage in online exchanges, linking their contributions to previous ones in the thread, understanding cultural implications and reacting appropriately. Can participate actively in an online discussion, stating and responding to opinions on topics of interest at some length, provided contributors avoid unusual or complex language and allow time for responses. Can engage in online exchanges between several participants, effectively linking their contributions to previous ones in the thread, provided a moderator helps manage the discussion. Can recognise misunderstandings and disagreements that arise in an online interaction and deal with them, provided the interlocutor(s) are willing to co-operate.
B1	Can engage in real-time online exchanges with more than one participant, recognising the communicative intentions of each contributor, but may not understand details or implications without further explanation. Can post online accounts of social events, experiences and activities referring to embedded links and media and sharing personal feelings. Can post a comprehensible contribution in an online discussion on a familiar topic of interest, provided they can prepare the text beforehand and use online tools to fill gaps in language and check accuracy. Can make personal online postings about experiences, feelings and events and respond individually to the comments of others in some detail, though lexical limitations sometimes cause repetition and inappropriate formulation.
A2+	Can introduce themselves and manage simple exchanges online, asking and answering questions and exchanging ideas on predictable everyday topics, provided enough time is allowed to formulate responses, and that they interact with one interlocutor at a time. Can make short descriptive online postings about everyday matters, social activities and feelings, with simple key details. Can comment on other people’s online postings, provided they are written/signed in simple language, reacting to embedded media by expressing feelings of surprise, interest and indifference in a simple way.

	Online conversation and discussion
A2	Can engage in basic social communication online (e.g. a simple message on a virtual card for special occasions, sharing news and making/confirming arrangements to meet). Can make brief positive or negative comments online about embedded links and media using a repertoire of basic language, though they will generally have to refer to an online translation tool and other resources.
A1	Can formulate very simple messages and personal online postings as a series of very short sentences about hobbies, likes/dislikes, etc., relying on the aid of a translation tool. Can use formulaic expressions and combinations of simple words/signs to post short positive and negative reactions to simple online postings and their embedded links and media, and can respond to further comments with standard expressions of thanks and apology.
Pre-A1	Can post simple online greetings, using basic formulaic expressions and emoticons. Can post online short simple statements about themselves (e.g. relationship status, nationality, occupation), provided they can select them from a menu and/or refer to an online translation tool.

Goal-oriented online transactions and collaboration

This scale focuses on the potentially collaborative nature of online interaction and transactions that have specific goals, as a regular feature of contemporary life. A rigid separation between written and oral does not really apply to online transactions, where multimodality is increasingly a key feature and resource, and the descriptors therefore assume the exploitation of different online media and tools according to context. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ purchasing goods and services online;
- ▶ engaging in transactions requiring negotiation of conditions, in a service as well as client role;
- ▶ participation in collaborative project work;
- ▶ dealing with communication problems.

Progression up the scale is characterised as follows: the move towards higher levels expands from basic transactions and information exchange at the A levels towards more sophisticated collaborative project work that is goal-oriented. This can be seen as a progression from filling in predictable online forms at Pre-A1, to solving various problems in order for the transaction to take place at the B levels, through to being able to participate in, and ultimately co-ordinate, group project work online at the C levels. One can also see such competences as progressing from reactive to proactive participation, and from simple to complex. Simple collaborative tasks appear at A2+, with a co-operative interlocutor, with small group project work from B1 and the ability to take a lead role in collaborative work from B2+. By C1, the user/learner can co-ordinate a group that is working on a project online, formulating and revising detailed instructions, evaluating proposals from team members, and providing clarifications in order to accomplish the shared tasks.

	Goal-oriented online transactions and collaboration
C2	Can resolve misunderstandings and deal effectively with frictions that arise during the collaborative process. Can provide guidance and add precision to the work of a group at the redrafting and editing stages of collaborative work.
C1	Can co-ordinate a group that is working on a project online, formulating and revising detailed instructions, evaluating proposals from team members, and providing clarifications in order to accomplish the shared tasks. Can deal with complex online transactions in a service role (e.g. applications with complicated requirements), adjusting language flexibly to manage discussions and negotiations. Can participate in complex projects requiring collaborative writing and redrafting as well as other forms of online collaboration, following and relaying instructions with precision in order to reach the goal. Can deal effectively with communication problems and cultural issues that arise in an online collaborative or transactional exchange by reformulating, clarifying and providing examples through media (visual, audio, graphic).

	Goal-oriented online transactions and collaboration
B2	Can take a lead role in online collaborative work within their area(s) of expertise, keeping the group on task by reminding it of roles, responsibilities and deadlines in order to achieve established goals. Can engage in online collaborative or transactional exchanges within their area(s) of expertise that require negotiation of conditions and explanation of complicated details and special requirements. Can deal with misunderstandings and unexpected problems that arise in online collaborative or transactional exchanges by responding politely and appropriately in order to help resolve the issue. Can collaborate online with a group that is working on a project, justifying proposals, seeking clarification and playing a supportive role in order to accomplish shared tasks.
B1	Can engage in online transactions that require an extended exchange of information, provided the interlocutor(s) avoid complex language and are willing to repeat and reformulate when necessary. Can interact online with a group that is working on a project, following straightforward instructions, seeking clarification and helping to accomplish the shared tasks. Can engage in online collaborative or transactional exchanges that require simple clarification or explanation of relevant details, such as registering for a course, tour or event, or applying for membership. Can interact online with a partner or small group working on a project, provided there are visual aids such as images, statistics and graphs to clarify more complex concepts. Can respond to instructions and ask questions or request clarifications in order to accomplish a shared task online.
A2	Can use formulaic language to respond to routine problems arising in online transactions (e.g. concerning availability of models and special offers, delivery dates, addresses). Can interact online with a supportive partner in a simple collaborative task, responding to basic instructions and seeking clarification, provided there are visual aids such as images, statistics or graphs to clarify the concepts involved. Can make simple online transactions (e.g. ordering goods or enrolling in a course) by filling in an online form or questionnaire, providing personal details and confirming acceptance of terms and conditions, declining extra services, etc. Can ask basic questions about the availability of a product or feature. Can respond to simple instructions and ask simple questions in order to accomplish a shared task online with the help of a supportive interlocutor.
A1	Can complete a very simple online purchase or application, providing basic personal information (e.g. name, e-mail or telephone number).
Pre-A1	Can make selections (e.g. choosing a product, size, colour) in a simple online purchase or application form, provided there is visual support.

3.3.2. Interaction strategies

Three descriptor scales are offered for interaction strategies: “Taking the floor” (“Turntaking”), “Co-operating” and “Asking for clarification”. Notice that “Taking the floor” (“Turntaking”), is in fact repeated in the section on “Pragmatic competence”, since it is a crucial part of discourse competence. This is the only instance in which a scale in the CEFR is repeated. In the scale for “Co-operating”, there are two aspects – cognitive strategies: framing, planning and organising ideational content, and collaborative strategies: handling interpersonal, relational aspects. In the section for mediation, these two aspects are further developed in new scales for cognitive strategies (“Collaborating to construct meaning”) and collaborative strategies (“Facilitating collaborative interaction with peers”). In many respects, these two scales represent a further development of the 2001 scale for “Co-operating”. However, since they go considerably further than the more discourse-focused approach of the “Co-operating” scale, it was decided to keep them under mediation.

Turntaking

This scale is concerned with the ability to take the initiative in discourse. As stated above, this ability can be viewed both as an interaction strategy (to take the turn) and as an integral aspect of discourse competence. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ initiating, maintaining and ending conversation;
- ▶ intervening in an existing conversation or discussion, often using a prefabricated expression to do so, or to gain time to think.

	Turntaking
C2	<i>No descriptors available; see C1</i>
C1	Can select a suitable phrase from a readily available range of discourse functions to preface their remarks appropriately in order to get the floor, or to gain time and keep the floor while thinking.
B2	Can intervene appropriately in discussion, exploiting appropriate language to do so. Can initiate, maintain and end discourse appropriately with effective turntaking. Can initiate discourse, take their turn when appropriate and end conversation when they need to, though they may not always do this elegantly. Can use stock phrases (e.g. "That's a difficult question to answer") to gain time and keep the turn while formulating what they want to express.
B1	Can intervene in a discussion on a familiar topic, using a suitable phrase to get the floor. Can initiate, maintain and close simple, face-to-face conversation on topics that are familiar or of personal interest.
A2	Can use simple techniques to start, maintain or end a short conversation. Can initiate, maintain and close simple, face-to-face conversation. Can ask for attention.
A1	<i>No descriptors available</i>
Pre-A1	<i>No descriptors available</i>

Co-operating

This scale concerns collaborative discourse moves intended to help a discussion develop. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ confirming comprehension (lower levels);
- ▶ ability to give feedback and relate one's own contribution to that of previous speakers/signers (higher levels);
- ▶ summarising the point reached in the discussion in order to take stock (B levels);
- ▶ inviting others to contribute.

Note: This scale is developed further in the scales for "Facilitating collaborative interaction with peers" and "Collaborating to construct meaning".

	Co-operating
C2	Can link contributions skilfully to those of others, widen the scope of the interaction and help steer it towards an outcome.
C1	Can relate own contribution skilfully to that of others.
B2+	Can give feedback on and follow up statements and inferences and so help the development of the discussion. Can summarise and evaluate the main points of discussion on matters within their academic or professional competence.

	Co-operating
B2	Can help the discussion along on familiar ground, confirming comprehension, inviting others in, etc. Can summarise the point reached at a particular stage in a discussion and propose the next steps.
B1	Can exploit a basic repertoire of language and strategies to help keep a conversation or discussion going. Can summarise the point reached in a discussion and so help focus the argument. Can repeat back part of what someone has said to confirm mutual understanding and help keep the development of ideas on course. Can invite others into the discussion.
A2	Can indicate when they are following.
A1	<i>No descriptors available</i>
Pre-A1	<i>No descriptors available</i>

Asking for clarification

This scale concerns intervening in an interaction to indicate whether one is following or not, and to ask follow-up questions on certain points, to check comprehension. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ indicating comprehension or a comprehension problem (lower levels);
- ▶ requesting repetition;
- ▶ asking follow-up questions to check comprehension or request more details.

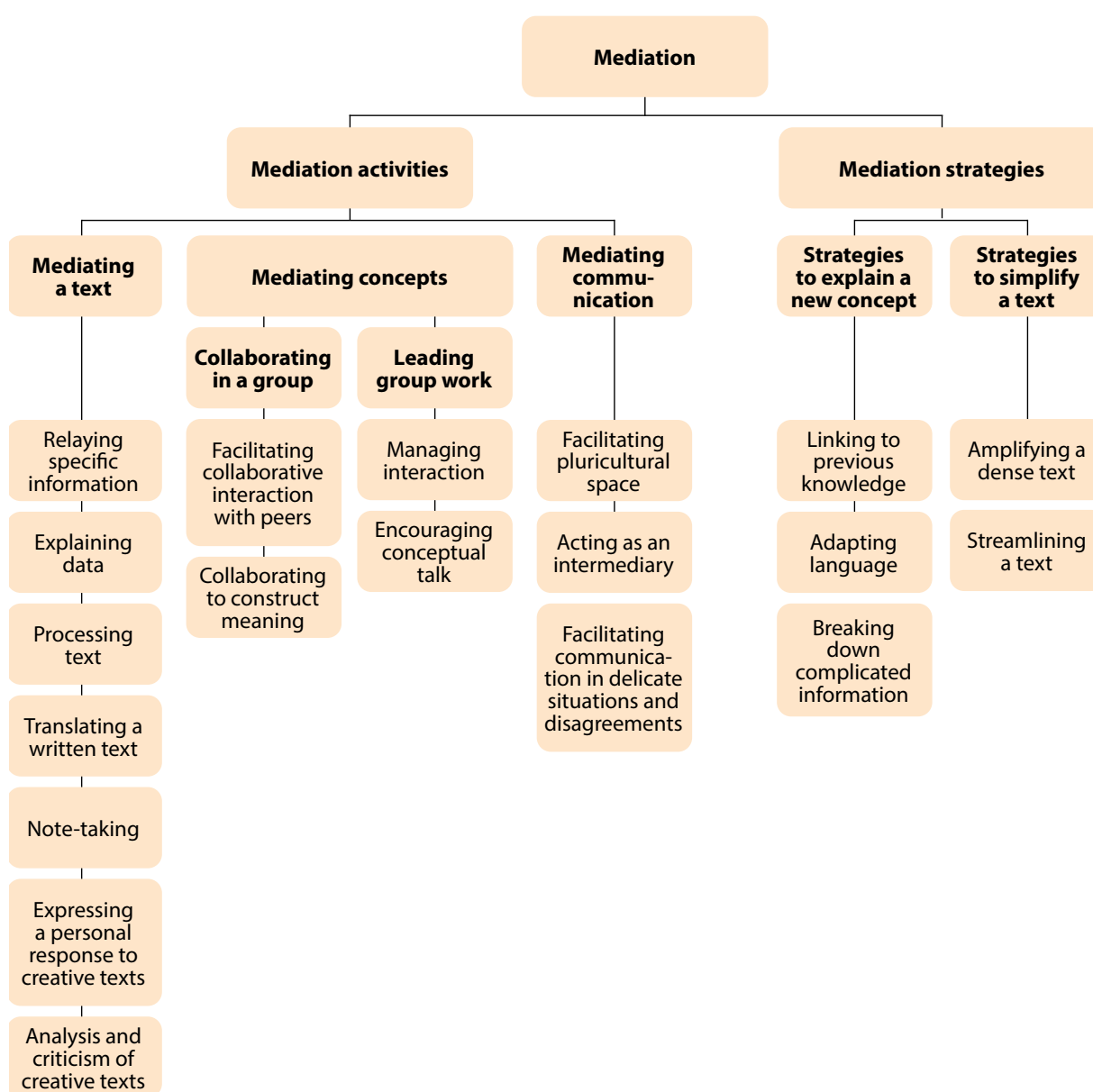
	Asking for clarification
C2	<i>No descriptors available; see C1</i>
C1	Can ask for explanation or clarification to ensure they understand complex, abstract ideas in professional or academic contexts, live or online.
B2	Can ask follow-up questions to check that they have understood what someone intended to say, and get clarification of ambiguous points. Can ask for explanation or clarification to ensure they understand complex, abstract ideas. Can formulate follow-up questions to a member of a group to clarify an issue that is implicit or poorly articulated.
B1	Can ask for further details and clarifications from other group members in order to move a discussion forward. Can ask someone to clarify or elaborate what they have just said.
A2	Can ask very simply for repetition when they do not understand. Can ask for clarification about key words/signs or phrases not understood, using stock phrases. Can indicate that they did not follow. Can signal non-understanding and ask for a word/sign to be spelt out.
A1	Can indicate with simple words/signs, intonation and gestures that they do not understand. Can express in a simple way that they do not understand.
Pre-A1	<i>No descriptors available</i>

3.4. MEDIATION

The development and validation of the scales for mediation is described in “[Developing illustrative descriptors of aspects of mediation for the CEFR](#)” (North and Piccardo 2016). The aim was to provide CEFR descriptors for a broader view of mediation, as presented in the paper “[Education, mobility, otherness – The mediation functions of schools](#)” (Coste and Cavalli 2015).

In mediation, the user/learner acts as a social agent who creates bridges and helps to construct or convey meaning, sometimes within the same language, sometimes across modalities (e.g. from spoken to signed or vice versa, in cross-modal communication) and sometimes from one language to another (cross-linguistic mediation). The focus is on the role of language in processes like creating the space and conditions for communicating and/or learning, collaborating to construct new meaning, encouraging others to construct or understand new meaning, and passing on new information in an appropriate form. The context can be social, pedagogic, cultural, linguistic or professional.

Figure 14 – Mediation activities and strategies



3.4.1. Mediation activities

There are many different aspects of mediation, but all share certain characteristics. For example, in mediation one is less concerned with one's own needs, ideas or expression than with those of the party or parties for whom one is mediating. A person who engages in mediation activity needs to have a well-developed emotional intelligence, or an openness to develop it, in order to have sufficient empathy for the viewpoints and emotional states of other participants in the communicative situation. The term "mediation" is also used to describe a social and cultural process of creating conditions for communication and co-operation, facing and hopefully defusing any delicate situations and tensions that may arise. Cross-linguistic and cross-modal mediation, in particular, inevitably involve social and cultural competence as well as plurilingual competence. This emphasises the fact that one cannot in practice completely separate one type of mediation from another. In adapting descriptors to their context, therefore, users should feel free to mix and match categories to suit their own perspective.

The scales for mediation are presented in three groups, reflecting the way in which mediation tends to occur.

"Mediating a text" involves passing on to another person the content of a text to which they do not have access, often because of linguistic, cultural, semantic or technical barriers. This is the main sense in which the 2001 CEFR text uses the term mediation. The first set of descriptor scales offered are for this, usually cross-linguistic, interpretation, which is increasingly being incorporated into language curricula (for example in Switzerland, Germany, Austria, Italy, Greece and Spain). However, the notion has been further developed to include mediating a text for oneself (for example in taking notes during a lecture) or in expressing reactions to texts, particularly creative and literary ones.

"Mediating concepts" refers to the process of facilitating access to knowledge and concepts for others, particularly if they may be unable to access this directly on their own. This is a fundamental aspect of parenting, mentoring, teaching and training, but also of collaborative learning and work. Mediating concepts involves two complementary aspects: on the one hand constructing and elaborating meaning and on the other hand facilitating and stimulating conditions that are conducive to such conceptual exchange and development.

"Mediating communication" aims to facilitate understanding and shape successful communication between users/learners who may have individual, sociocultural, sociolinguistic or intellectual differences in standpoint. The mediator tries to have a positive influence on aspects of the dynamic relationship between all the participants, including the relationship with themselves. Often, the context of the mediation will be an activity in which participants have shared communicative objectives, but this need not necessarily be the case. The skills involved are relevant to diplomacy, negotiation, pedagogy and dispute resolution, but also to everyday social and/or workplace interactions. Mediating communication is thus primarily concerned with personal encounters. This is not a closed list – users may well be able to think of other types of mediation activities not included here.

Overall mediation

	Overall mediation
C2	Can mediate effectively and naturally, taking on different roles according to the needs of the people and situation involved, identifying nuances and undercurrents and guiding a sensitive or delicate discussion. Can explain in clear, fluent, well-structured language the way facts and arguments are presented, conveying evaluative aspects and most nuances precisely, and pointing out sociocultural implications (e.g. use of register, understatement, irony and sarcasm).
C1	Can act effectively as a mediator, helping to maintain positive interaction by interpreting different perspectives, managing ambiguity, anticipating misunderstandings and intervening diplomatically in order to redirect the conversation. Can build on different contributions to a discussion, stimulating reasoning with a series of questions. Can convey clearly and fluently in well-structured language the significant ideas in long, complex texts, whether or not they relate to their own fields of interest, including evaluative aspects and most nuances.

	Overall mediation
B2	Can establish a supportive environment for sharing ideas and facilitate discussion of delicate issues, showing appreciation of different perspectives, encouraging people to explore issues and adjusting sensitively the way they express things. Can build on others' ideas, making suggestions for ways forward. Can convey the main content of well-structured but long and propositionally complex texts on subjects within their fields of professional, academic and personal interest, clarifying the opinions and purposes of speakers/signers.
	Can work collaboratively with people from different backgrounds, creating a positive atmosphere by providing support, asking questions to identify common goals, comparing options for how to achieve them and explaining suggestions for what to do next. Can further develop others' ideas, pose questions that invite reactions from different perspectives and propose a solution or next steps. Can convey detailed information and arguments reliably, e.g. the significant point(s) contained in complex but well-structured texts within their fields of professional, academic and personal interest.
B1	Can collaborate with people from other backgrounds, showing interest and empathy by asking and answering simple questions, formulating and responding to suggestions, asking whether people agree, and proposing alternative approaches. Can convey the main points made in long texts expressed in uncomplicated language on topics of personal interest, provided they can check the meaning of certain expressions.
	Can introduce people from different backgrounds, showing awareness that some questions may be perceived differently, and invite other people to contribute their expertise and experience as well as their views. Can convey information given in clear, well-structured informational texts on subjects that are familiar or of personal or current interest, although lexical limitations cause difficulty with formulation at times.
A2	Can play a supportive role in interaction, provided other participants speak/sign slowly and that one or more of the participants helps them to contribute and to express their suggestions. Can convey relevant information contained in clearly structured, short, simple, informational texts, provided the texts concern concrete, familiar subjects and are formulated in simple everyday language.
	Can use simple words/signs to ask someone to explain something. Can recognise when difficulties occur and indicate in simple language the apparent nature of a problem. Can convey the main point(s) involved in short, simple conversations or texts on everyday subjects of immediate interest, provided these are expressed clearly in simple language.
A1	Can use simple words/signs and non-verbal signals to show interest in an idea. Can convey simple, predictable information of immediate interest given in short, simple signs and notices, posters and programmes.
Pre-A1	<i>No descriptors available</i>

3.4.1.1. Mediating a text

For all the descriptors in the scales in this section, Language A and Language B may be different languages, varieties or modalities of the same language, different registers of the same variety, or any combination of the above. However, they may also be identical: the CEFR 2001 is clear that mediation may also be in one language. Alternatively, mediation may involve several languages, varieties or modalities; there may be a Language C and even conceivably a Language D in the communicative situation concerned. The descriptors for mediation are equally applicable in each case. Users may thus wish to specify precisely which languages/varieties/modalities are involved when adapting the descriptors to their context. For ease of use, reference is made in the descriptors to just Language A and Language B.

It is also important to underline that the illustrative descriptors offered in this section are not intended to describe the competences of professional interpreters and translators. The descriptors focus on language competences,

thinking of what a user/learner can do in this area in informal everyday situations. Translation and interpretation competences and strategies are an entirely different field.

Relaying specific information

Relaying specific information refers to the way some particular piece of information of immediate relevance is extracted from the target text and relayed to someone else. Here, the emphasis is on the specific content that is relevant, rather than the main ideas or lines of argument presented in a text. “Relaying specific information” is related to “Reading for orientation” (although the information concerned may have been given orally in a public announcement or series of instructions). The user/learner scans the source text for the necessary information and then relays this to a recipient. Key concepts operationalised in the two scales include the following:

- ▶ relaying information on times, places, prices, etc. from announcements or written/signed artefacts;
- ▶ relaying sets of directions or instructions;
- ▶ relaying specific, relevant information from informational texts like guides and brochures, from correspondence, or from longer, complex texts like articles, reports, etc.

Progression up the scales is characterised as follows: at Pre-A1 and A1 the user/learner can relay simple information like times, places and numbers, whereas at A2 they can cope with the information in simple texts like instructions and announcements. By B1, they can select and relay specific, relevant information in straightforward oral announcements and in texts like leaflets, brochure entries and letters. By B2, they can reliably relay detailed information from formal correspondence or particular sections of long, complex texts. As with the scale for “Information exchange”, there are no descriptors for the C levels since such purely informational tasks do not require a C level of proficiency.

In the two scales, Language A and Language B may be different languages, varieties of the same language, registers of the same variety, modalities of the same language or variety, or any combination of the above. However, they may also be identical. In the former case, users should specify the languages/varieties/modalities concerned; in the latter case, users should simply remove the parts in brackets.

Relaying specific information		
	Relaying specific information in speech or sign	Relaying specific information in writing
C2	<i>No descriptors available; see C1</i>	<i>No descriptors available; see B2</i>
C1	Can explain (in Language B) the relevance of specific information found in a particular section of a long, complex text (in Language A).	<i>No descriptors available; see B2</i>
B2	Can relay (in Language B) which presentations given (in Language A) at a conference, or which articles in a book (in Language A) are particularly relevant for a specific purpose.	Can relay in writing (in Language B) which presentations at a conference (given in Language A) were relevant, pointing out which would be worth detailed consideration. Can relay in writing (in Language B) the relevant point(s) contained in propositionally complex but well-structured texts (in Language A) within their fields of professional, academic and personal interest. Can relay in writing (in Language B) the relevant point(s) contained in an article (in Language A) from an academic or professional journal.
B1	Can relay (in Language B) the main point(s) contained in formal correspondence and/or reports (in Language A) on general subjects and on subjects related to their fields of interest.	Can relay in a written report (in Language B) relevant decisions that were taken in a meeting (in Language A). Can relay in writing (in Language B) the significant point(s) contained in formal correspondence (in Language A).
	Can relay (in Language B) the content of public announcements and messages delivered clearly at normal speed (in Language A). Can relay (in Language B) the contents of detailed instructions or directions, provided these are clearly articulated (in Language A). Can relay (in Language B) specific information given in straightforward informational texts (e.g. leaflets, brochure entries, notices and letters or e-mails) (in Language A).	Can relay in writing (in Language B) specific information points contained in texts delivered (in Language A) on familiar subjects (e.g. calls, announcements and instructions). Can relay in writing (in Language B) specific, relevant information contained in straightforward informational texts (in Language A) on familiar subjects. Can relay in writing (in Language B) specific information given in a straightforward recorded message (left in Language A), provided the topics concerned are familiar and the delivery is slow and clear.

Relaying specific information		
	Relaying specific information in speech or sign	Relaying specific information in writing
A2	Can relay (in Language B) the point made in a clear announcement (in Language A) concerning familiar everyday subjects, though they may have to simplify the message and search for words/signs. Can relay (in Language B) specific, relevant information contained in short, simple texts, labels and notices (in Language A) on familiar subjects.	Can relay in writing (in Language B) specific information contained in short simple informational texts (in Language A), provided the texts concern concrete, familiar subjects and are composed in simple everyday language.
	Can relay (in Language B) the point made in short, clear, simple messages, instructions and announcements, provided these are expressed slowly and clearly in simple language (in Language A). Can relay (in Language B) in a simple way a series of short, simple instructions, provided the original (in Language A) is clearly and slowly articulated.	Can list (in Language B) the main points of short, clear, simple messages and announcements (given in Language A), provided they are clearly and slowly articulated. Can list (in Language B) specific information contained in simple texts (in Language A) on everyday subjects of immediate interest or need.
A1	Can relay (in Language B) simple, predictable information about times and places given in short, simple statements (delivered in Language A).	Can list (in Language B) names, numbers, prices and very simple information of immediate interest in oral texts (in Language A), provided the articulation is very slow and clear, with repetition.
Pre-A1	Can relay (in Language B) simple instructions about places and times (given in Language A), provided these are repeated very slowly and clearly. Can relay (in Language B) very basic information (e.g. numbers and prices) from short, simple, illustrated texts (in Language A).	Can list (in Language B) names, numbers, prices and very simple information from texts (in Language A) that are of immediate interest, that are composed in very simple language and contain illustrations.

Explaining data

This scale refers to the transformation into a verbal text of information found in figures (graphs, diagrams, etc.). The user/learner might do this as part of a PowerPoint presentation, or when explaining to a friend or colleague the key information given in graphics accompanying an article, a weather forecast or financial information. Key concepts operationalised in the two scales include the following:

- ▶ describing graphic material on familiar topics (e.g. flow charts, weather charts);
- ▶ presenting trends in graphs;
- ▶ commenting on bar charts;
- ▶ selecting and interpreting the salient, relevant points of empirical data presented graphically.

Progression up the scale is characterised as follows: the higher the level, the more complex the visual information is, from everyday visuals (e.g. weather charts) to complex visuals accompanying academic and highly professional texts. Secondly, the higher the level, the more complex the communicative acts involved (interpreting source data, describing the salient points, explaining in detail). There are no descriptors at A1 and A2. At A2+ the user/learner can describe simple visuals on familiar topics, while at B1 they can describe overall trends and detailed information in diagrams in their fields of interest. At B2 the focus is on the reliable interpretation of complex data, while at C2 the user/learner can interpret and describe various forms of empirical data from conceptually complex research.

In the two scales, Language A and Language B may be different languages, varieties of the same language, registers of the same variety, modalities of the same language or variety, or any combination of the above. However, they may also be identical. In the former case, users should specify the languages/varieties/modalities concerned; in the latter case, users should simply remove the parts in brackets.

Explaining data (in graphs, diagrams, etc.)		
	Explaining data in speech or sign	Explaining data in writing
C2	Can interpret and describe clearly and reliably (in Language B) various forms of empirical data and visually organised information (with text in Language A) from conceptually complex research concerning academic or professional topics.	Can interpret and present in writing (in Language B) various forms of empirical data (with text in Language A) from conceptually complex research on academic or professional topics.
C1	Can interpret and describe clearly and reliably (in Language B) the salient points and details contained in complex diagrams and other visually organised information (with text in Language A) on complex academic or professional topics.	Can interpret and present clearly and reliably in writing (in Language B) the salient, relevant points contained in complex diagrams and other visually organised data (with text in Language A) on complex academic or professional topics.
B2	Can interpret and describe reliably (in Language B) detailed information contained in complex diagrams, charts and other visually organised information (with text in Language A) on topics in their fields of interest.	Can interpret and present reliably in writing (in Language B) detailed information from diagrams and visually organised data in their fields of interest (with text in Language A).
B1	Can interpret and describe (in Language B) detailed information in diagrams in their fields of interest (with text in Language A), even though lexical gaps may cause hesitation or imprecise formulation.	Can interpret and present in writing (in Language B) the overall trends shown in simple diagrams (e.g. graphs, bar charts) (with text in Language A), explaining the important points in more detail, given the help of a dictionary or other reference materials.
	Can interpret and describe (in Language B) overall trends shown in simple diagrams (e.g. graphs, bar charts) (with text in Language A), even though lexical limitations cause difficulty with formulation at times.	Can describe in simple sentences (in Language B) the main facts shown in visuals on familiar topics (e.g. a weather map, a basic flow chart) (with text in Language A).
A2	Can interpret and describe (in Language B) simple visuals on familiar topics (e.g. a weather map, a basic flow chart) (with text in Language A), even though pauses, false starts and reformulation may be very evident.	No descriptors available
	No descriptors available	
A1	No descriptors available	No descriptors available
Pre-A1	No descriptors available	No descriptors available

Processing text

Processing text involves understanding the information and/or arguments included in the source text and then transferring these to another text, usually in a more condensed form, in a way that is appropriate to the context. In other words, the outcome represents a condensing and/or reformulating of the original information and arguments, focusing on the main points and ideas in the source text. The key word in the processing scales is “summarising”. Whereas in “Relaying specific information” the user/learner will almost certainly not read the whole text (unless the information required is well hidden!), in “Processing text” they have first to fully understand all the main points in the source text. “Processing text” is thus related to “Reading for information and argument” (sometimes called reading for detail, or careful reading), although the information concerned may have been given orally in a presentation or lecture. The user/learner may then choose to present the information to the recipient in a completely different order, depending on the goal of the communicative encounter. Key concepts operationalised in the two scales include the following:

- ▶ summarising the main points in a source text;
- ▶ collating such information and arguments from different sources;
- ▶ recognising and clarifying to the recipient the intended audience, the purpose and viewpoint of the original.

Progression up the scale is characterised as follows: in general, as one moves up the scale, the more cognitively and linguistically demanding the process described by the descriptor, the greater the variety of text types, the higher the degree of complexity of the texts and the abstraction of the topics, and the more sophisticated the vocabulary. There is no descriptor for A1. At A2, the learner may need to supplement their limited repertoire with gestures, drawing or expressions embedded from other languages. At lower levels, source texts are simpler and more factual, concerning everyday topics and topics of immediate interest. By B1, texts include TV programmes, conversations and well-structured texts on topics of interest. By B2, the user/learner can synthesise and report information from a number of sources, for example interviews, documentaries, films and complex texts in their fields of interest. By the C levels, they can summarise long, demanding professional or academic texts in well-structured language, inferring attitudes and implicit opinions, and explaining subtle distinctions in the presentation or facts and arguments.

In the two scales, Language A and Language B may be different languages, varieties of the same language, registers of the same variety, modalities of the same language or variety, or any combination of the above. However, they may also be identical. In the former case, users should specify the languages/varieties/modalities concerned; in the latter case, users should simply remove the parts in brackets.

Processing text		
	Processing text in speech or sign	Processing text in writing
C2	Can explain (in Language B) inferences when links or implications are not made explicit (in Language A), and point out the sociocultural implications of the form of expression (e.g. understatement, irony, sarcasm).	Can explain in writing (in Language B) the way that facts and arguments are presented in a text (in Language A), particularly when someone else's position is being reported, drawing attention to the use of understatement, veiled criticism, irony and sarcasm. Can summarise information from different sources, reconstructing arguments and accounts in a coherent presentation of the overall result.
C1	Can summarise (in Language B) long, demanding texts (in Language A). Can summarise (in Language B) discussion (in Language A) on matters within their academic or professional competence, elaborating and weighing up different points of view and identifying the most significant points. Can summarise clearly in well-structured language (in Language B) the main points made in complex texts (in Language A) in fields of specialisation other than their own, although they may occasionally check particular technical concepts. Can explain (in Language B) subtle distinctions in the presentation of facts and arguments (in Language A). Can exploit information and arguments from a complex text (in Language A) to discuss a topic (in Language B), glossing with evaluative comments, adding their opinion, etc. Can explain (in Language B) the attitude or opinion expressed in a source text (in Language A) on a specialised topic, supporting inferences they make with reference to specific passages in the original.	Can summarise in writing (in Language B) long, complex texts (in Language A), interpreting the content appropriately, provided they can occasionally check the precise meaning of unusual, technical terms. Can summarise in writing a long and complex text (in Language A) (e.g. an academic article, article providing political analysis, novel extract, editorial, literary review, report or extract from a scientific book) for a specific audience, respecting the style and register of the original.
B2+	Can summarise clearly in well-structured language (in Language B) the information and arguments contained in complex texts (in Language A) on a wide range of subjects related to their fields of interest and specialisation. Can summarise (in Language B) the main points of complex discussions (in Language A), weighing up the different points of view presented.	Can summarise in writing (in Language B) the main content of well-structured but propositionally complex texts (in Language A) on subjects within their fields of professional, academic and personal interest. Can compare, contrast and synthesise in writing (in Language B) the information and viewpoints contained in academic and professional publications (in Language A) in their fields of special interest. Can explain in writing (in Language B) the viewpoint articulated in a complex text (in Language A), supporting inferences they make with reference to specific information in the original.

Processing text		
	Processing text in speech or sign	Processing text in writing
B2	Can synthesise and report (in Language B) information and arguments from a number of sources (in Language A). Can summarise (in Language B) a wide range of factual and imaginative texts (in Language A), commenting on and discussing contrasting points of view and the main themes. Can summarise (in Language B) the important points made in longer, complex texts (in Language A) on subjects of current interest, including their fields of special interest. Can recognise the intended audience of a text (in Language A) on a topic of interest and explain (in Language B) the purpose, attitudes and opinion of the author. Can summarise (in Language B) extracts from news items, interviews or documentaries containing opinions, arguments and discussions (in Language A). Can summarise (in Language B) the plot and sequence of events in a film or play (in Language A).	Can summarise in writing (in Language B) the main content of complex texts (in Language A) on subjects related to their fields of interest and specialisation.
B1+	Can summarise (in Language B) the main points made in long texts (in Language A) on topics in their fields of interest, provided they can check the meaning of certain expressions. Can summarise (in Language B) a short narrative or article, talk, discussion, interview or documentary (in Language A) and answer further questions about details. Can collate short pieces of information from several sources (in Language A) and summarise them (in Language B) for somebody else.	Can summarise in writing (in Language B) the information and arguments contained in texts (in Language A) on subjects of general or personal interest.